“Something is wrong with me because I don't look like others.”

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Where it often comes from

Difference is often treated as deficiency, by media, peers, and sometimes medical language. Children especially take this in as fact about themselves.

What Scripture teaches

God said, “Let Us make man in Our image” (Genesis 1:26). Every person is a unique image-bearer. “God looked upon all that He had made, and indeed, it was very good.” “For You formed my inmost being; You knit me together in my mother’s womb.” “You made him a little lower than the angels; You crowned him with glory and honor.” Variation in the human family is part of creation. You are not wrong, and you do not have to match anyone.

> *“And God looked upon all that He had made, and indeed, it was very good. And there was evening, and there was morning—the sixth day”* (Genesis 1:31).

Also see

> “So God created man in His own image; in the image of God He created him; male and female He created them” (Genesis 1:27).

> “For You formed my inmost being; You knit me together in my mother’s womb” (Psalm 139:13).

> “You made him a little lower than the angels; You crowned him with glory and honor” (Psalm 8:5).

> “I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well” (Psalm 139:14).

Common self-statements

- I am wrong.
- Normal looks are right.
- I was made badly.
- I am a mistake.
- There must be something wrong with me.
- I do not belong in the human family.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing there is a right way to look and I do not match.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will always be seen as wrong.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling different and concluding that I am wrong.
- Labeling: Calling myself wrong.

Challenging questions

- Who taught me that different means wrong?
- What does Scripture say God thought of what He made?
- What is beautiful about variety?

- Who celebrates my uniqueness?
- How can I speak kindly about my body?
- What would I tell a child who looks like me?

Truth summary

> I am not wrong. I am made in God's image and called very good. Variety is part of creation, and I can embrace who I am.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- God, Creator
- Guilt/Shame
- Prejudice
- Love, By God

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Love

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Who Am I — Casting Crowns
Being known and cared for by God rests on His love rather than personal importance.

You Say — Lauren Daigle
God's loving assessment challenges identity based only on weakness or feelings.

Is He Worthy — Andrew Peterson
Honest recognition of a broken world can lead to hope in Christ's final restoration.

Jesus Loves Me — Gaither Vocal Band
This familiar hymn places confidence in Jesus' love rather than personal strength.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "Something is wrong with me because I don't look like others"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Something is wrong with me because I don't look like others." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who taught me that different means wrong?
- ☐ What does Scripture say God thought of what He made?
- ☐ What is beautiful about variety?
- ☐ Who celebrates my uniqueness?
- ☐ How can I speak kindly about my body?
- ☐ What would I tell a child who looks like me?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God called His creation very good.
- ☐ I am made in God's image.
- ☐ God knit me together.
- ☐ I am crowned with glory and honor.
- ☐ Variety is part of creation.
- ☐ I am not wrong.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Genesis 1:31
  "And God looked upon all that He had made, and indeed, it was very good. And there was evening, and there was morning—the sixth day."
- ☐ Genesis 1:27
  "So God created man in His own image; in the image of God He created him; male and female He created them."
- ☐ Psalm 139:13
  "For You formed my inmost being; You knit me together in my mother's womb."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Called good: Each day, say one thing about yourself that is true and good.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Genesis 1:31 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God called all He made very good.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- ☐ Note the source. Write who taught you different is wrong.
- ☐ Speak kindly. Replace "wrong" with "different."
- ☐ Seek affirmation. Spend time with people who celebrate you.
- ☐ Read Genesis 1. Note "very good."

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Something is wrong with me because I don't look like others": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Called good
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Something is wrong with me because I don't look like others.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Creator, You called what You made very good. Heal the hurt of being told I am wrong, and help me see myself as You do. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.